different, depending on environments. To help with this, Django provides the `{% static %}` template tag, which sets the base URL and handles the full file name.

The tags you encountered in chapter 3 were all part of the default tag library. Although `{% static %}` comes with Django, it isn't part of the main module, you have to load it separately. The `{% load %}` tag works like the `import` statement in Python, adding tags from the loaded module into the template's namespace. Somewhat confusingly, the name of the module and the name of the tag are the same. This is similar to some functions found in the Python standard library, like `from pprint import pprint`.

The `{% static %}` tag returns a URL and gets used inside `<img>` and `<link>` HTML tags, similar to how the `{% url %}` tag gets used in an HTML anchor (`<a>`). The argument to `{% static %}` is the name of the static file, relative to the static directory.

The static directory is where you keep your static files in your project. This may be different from where they are deployed in production. Common practice is to create a directory called *static* in your project folder, which you point at by adding a configuration to settings.py. As there are several kinds of static files, I usually create separate subdirectories for images, JavaScript, and CSS to keep them organized. Create a directory in your project for your static files and one under that for the images:

```
(venv) RiffMates$ mkdir static
(venv) RiffMates$ mkdir static/img
```

The RiffMates logo file goes in RiffMates/static/img. To tell Django about your new static directory, edit RiffMates/RiffMates/settings.py, and look for the existing setting named `STATIC_URL`. Underneath that, add the following configuration:

```
# RiffMates/RiffMates/settings.py
...
STATIC_URL = '/static/'
STATICFILES_DIRS = (
    BASE_DIR / 'static',
)
```

Static files have a base URL of /static/. This is the default value provided when Django created settings.py.

Your static files are in the static directory underneath your project directory. Remember that BASE_DIR is a pathlib.Path object, so the / operator creates a new Path.

For production, there are a couple more steps you can learn about in appendix B. The development server knows all about `STATICFILES_DIR`, and with the configuration done, it will serve your logo.

With all that in place, it is time to write the home page. The following listing contains an example—feel free to be more creative. The content goes in RiffMates/templates/home.html.

Listing 7.13 Template for the home page that includes a static file

```
<!-- RiffMates/templates/home.html -->
{% extends "base.html" %}
{% load static %}
```

Load the tag module that includes the {% static %} tag.